

THIS IS TECHNOLOGY, CULTURE AND SCIENCE WITH A DIFFERENCE, AND THAT DIFFERENCE IS USUALLY ENOUGH TO MAKE MOST NORMAL PEOPLE GO "WTF?"

ALT this month:

Do you find this section illogical? Well, we'll explain logical fallacies to change your thought process first, and then we'll dive into the mind of a typical geek. Not brainwashed enough? Step into the world of an AI psychologist treating a talking squirrel, a plant and more. If you've had enough weirdness by this part, our Auto section and DGT will provide just the right relief.



Teens worried about smartphone use

A new study conducted by the Pew Research Center indicates that it is not only the parents of teens who are concerned about inordinate time spent with smartphones. The teens themselves are worried about the quantity and quality of the time they spend engaged in smartphone use. <https://dgit.in/pewteen>

WHAT'S NEW

The CryptoKitties mania is fading already, but it is the start for NFTs

About six months ago, CryptoKitties were the hottest thing in distributed ledger technologies. CryptoKitties is a blockchain based game, where you can collect and breed one of a kind digital cats. Think of them as collectibles, but the collectibles can spawn new collectibles. Breed two cryptokitties that you own, and you get a third, totally unique cryptokitty. There are new cattributes and mewtations emerging all the time. There have



been numerous clones of it, but the trend of crypto collectibles is already fading. However, the game raised awareness over the concept of NFTs, or non-fungible tokens. NFTs are unique from units of cryptocurrencies, tokens with unique properties. The NFTs can be bought or traded, but not

copied. Each NFT is unique. Cryptokitties and its clones are just the beginning of the new ways in which NFTs can be put to use.

<https://dgit.in/cryptkts>

US Senate hearing on why we should look for aliens

This is a senate hearing very different from the other ones making the news. Scientists and academia from US universities and NASA answered questions to the senate, on why the congress should fund the search for extraterrestrial life. One of the biggest considerations is that exciting projects like this attracts people to the field, and the result is technological progress that benefits the entire society. Additionally, the US risks getting



behind other countries, such as China, if funding for these initiatives dry up. One of the senators asked a scientist if there are advanced civilisations out there

that humans might never be able to find. Ellen Stofan, the director of the Smithsonian National Air and Space Museum explained that the right approach was to first identify the variety of life possible, and the kind of conditions that would be suitable to harbour them. Understanding that would enable humans to identify the best locations in the galaxy to hunt for other advanced civilisations.

<https://dgit.in/whyseti>



The Slenderman phenomenon

Slenderman can be considered the first breakout creepypasta, copy pasted words often in combination with shooped images that have evolved over time to elicit a response of horror. Slenderman has escaped from the realms of dodgy underground forums.

<https://dgit.in/slenderman>



Bacteria painting the Mona Lisa

This is not a photograph of the famous painting, but an image created by bacteria. A team of researchers used light sensitive bacteria to make them accumulate in the pattern seen above. A projector lens was replaced with a microscope lens to realise the image.

<https://dgit.in/bacpaint>



Kalashnikov Killer Robot

The weapons company Kalashnikov introduced a 13 foot tall golden killer robot at the Army 2018 fair in Moscow. The bulletproof bipedal walker has a cabin for an operator. The walker weighs 4.5 tons, and has two grasping arms to manipulate weapons and objects.

<https://dgit.in/knowbot>